hithozha

Founder Pack — Board Review, Competitor Map, Consumer Panel, Pricing & Offer

Compiled 2026-10-13. Built with the *founder-skill* pack (github.com/Jakeschincariol/founder-skill), MIT licensed. The pack's CFO, marketing, brand, operations, launch-plan and final business-plan steps were not run in this pass — this document covers the board, competitor, consumer-panel, pricing and offer steps only.

Read this with two things in mind: (1) the “consumer panel” is 20 simulated buyers, not real customers — useful for surfacing objections and wording, not as a conversion forecast; language models lean agreeable, so treat buy rates as an upper bound. (2) The offer step's before/after re-test panel was interrupted partway (16 of 20 simulated buyers answered) and is reported as a partial, directional read, not a final tally.

The Idea

hithozha

• What it is: A bilingual (Tamil/English) freelance marketplace app — clients post jobs or buy fixed-price service packages, freelancers deliver. A localized, Tamil Nadu-first Fiverr/Upwork hybrid, built on Expo/React Native + Supabase, with a web presence at hithozha.in.

• Who it is for: Tamil-speaking users in Tamil Nadu, India specifically — not generic India-wide. Two sides: clients (individuals and companies posting work) and freelancers (verified individuals delivering it), across 16 broad categories and 346 subcategories (writing, design, video, programming, marketing, business/finance, admin support, engineering, education, health, lifestyle/local services, gaming, web3, digital products).

• What it sells, at what price: Not a single product — a two-sided marketplace. Revenue is a commission on completed orders (default ~5%, reduced for freelancers on paid plans), plus freelancer and client subscription plans that raise open-job/package limits and lower commission, plus an internal admin-granted token system. Freelancers must pass identity verification before they can publish packages.

• Where and how: Mobile app (Expo/React Native) plus a web app at hithozha.in. Already built and live in GitHub; production deployment status is currently being sorted out (the Vercel project that should serve hithozha.in was found to still be linked to an older, unrelated repo, and the Supabase production database migration for a just-shipped 16/346-category taxonomy overhaul is pending).

• Budget and constraints: Already built, not pre-launch — this is a test of a business already in motion, not a new concept. No invented budget figures here; ongoing costs are Vercel/Supabase hosting plus Cashfree payment processing fees. Open questions for the board: real launch traction/user numbers are not yet established in this conversation.

1. Board Review

Board verdict: hithozha

Vote: 2 fund if, 1 pass (Offers: FUND IF, Monopoly: PASS, Product: FUND IF) **Average score: 3.7 / 10** (Offers 4, Monopoly 3, Product 4)

The risks more than one member raised

These go first because three independent readings of the same brief landed on them without being told to.

1. **The catalog is two different businesses wearing one skin.** All three members flagged this as the single biggest problem, in their own words: Offers called it "cold-start liquidity spread across too many markets at once," Monopoly called it "breadth works against the small-market thesis," Product called it "two different products wearing one skin." 346 subcategories span globally-tradeable digital gig work (competing with Fiverr/Upwork on their own turf) and hyper-local in-person services (competing with a free WhatsApp referral or JustDial). These need different discovery flows, different trust mechanics, and arguably different go-to-market plays — launching all of it at once dilutes the one real narrowing move (Tamil Nadu, Tamil language) that every member agreed was the strongest card in hand.

2. **The trust/verification model has an unexplained seam.** Freelancers need identity verification to publish a fixed-price package, but can apparently bid on jobs without it, and the brief states the fraud/trust outcome of that split is unknown. All three members called this out as a real risk, not a nitpick — Product put it sharpest: "quality erodes fastest at the handoff nobody fully specified."

3. **The production pipeline is currently broken, and that's part of the product, not separate from it.** The Vercel project expected to serve hithozha.in is linked to an unrelated older repo, and the Supabase migration for the new 346-subcategory taxonomy that just shipped to `main` is pending and manual. Product flagged this hardest (a mismatch between what the taxonomy migration changed and what's actually live would orphan listings or show a first-time visitor a broken catalog), and Offers independently said not to spend on acquisition until this is fixed.

4. **No visible distribution/liquidity plan.** Raised most sharply by Monopoly: nothing in the brief describes how the first 100 freelancers and first 100 clients actually show up in the same place at the same time. Without that, the Tamil Nadu narrowing is "a map, not a strategy."

The conditions, merged into one checklist

■ **Narrow the launch focus to one side of the catalog** — either the globally-tradeable digital-gig subcategories or the hyper-local in-person ones — and treat the other as a later expansion, not a parallel day-one offering. (All three members, independently.)

■ **Close the verification gap.** Either require identity verification before any paid engagement (job or package), or document the specific trust/dispute mechanism that makes an unverified job-bidder acceptable to a client — and say which one, on purpose, not by omission.

■ **Ship a concrete guarantee or escrow mechanism** (e.g. client payment held until delivery is confirmed, with a defined refund path) before increasing paid acquisition spend. (Offers.)

■ **Fix the production pipeline end to end** before the next feature push: correct the Vercel-to-repo linkage, run and verify the Supabase taxonomy migration in production, and put some minimal pre-release checklist

or CI/CD in place so this gap doesn't repeat. (Product, Offers.)

- **State a concrete, costed channel for the first 100 freelancers and first 100 clients** — not a hope, a plan. (Monopoly.)
- **Get real usage numbers, even from a small pilot**, rather than continuing to build catalog breadth on an unvalidated base. (Monopoly.)

Most of these conditions are exactly what `/founder-competitors`, `/founder-consumer`, and `/founder-cfo` are built to test — the board flagged the open questions, it didn't guess at the answers.

The strongest version of this business the board can see

Not "a Tamil Nadu Fiverr with 346 categories." The strongest version is narrower: **a trusted, Tamil-language marketplace for one tightly-scoped slice of hyper-local, in-person services in Tamil Nadu** — the side where a language/trust edge over a WhatsApp group or JustDial listing is real and hard to copy quickly, rather than the side where the product is competing head-on with Fiverr and Upwork's existing global liquidity on their own terms. That version picks one or two subcategories with the clearest evidence of real demand, builds a verification and guarantee/escrow story solid enough that a first-time user trusts a stranger in their home, fixes the production pipeline so the live app matches what shipped, and proves liquidity in that one corner before the catalog grows back out to 346. This differs from the pitch as given — the pitch is breadth-first across 16 categories; the board's strongest version is depth-first in one.

Next step: `/founder-competitors` — map who already serves Tamil Nadu buyers in the candidate hyper-local categories (and what Fiverr/Upwork charge the digital-gig side), before `/founder-consumer` tests whether a Tamil Nadu buyer actually switches.

2. Competitor Map

Competitor map: hithozha

Public sources only, every fact linked. Where a figure could not be independently verified in this pass, it is marked so rather than guessed at.

The table

Name	Type	Price/take rate	What it sells	Rating / reviews
Fiverr	Direct	20% flat seller commission + ~5.5% buyer fee (~27.7% total take rate)	Fixed-price gigs, digital/creative	Not found this pass
Upwork	Direct	Variable 0-15% freelancer fee (since May 2025), ~10% typical	Bid-based jobs + fixed contracts, digital/creative/professional	Not found this pass
Urban Company	Direct	25% commission (cut from 30% in 2021)	Fixed-price, verified-pro home services	~4.8 / ~1.17M (iOS, India, aggregated)
JustDial	Indirect	~■2,000/mo paid listing (unconfirmed)	Local business directory, lead-gen only (no checkout)	1.7 / 3-62 (self-selected complaint sites)
Workers app	Indirect	Not found this pass	Local-services marketplace, supports Tamil among 5 languages	Not found this pass
ManyJobs.com	Indirect	Free to seekers (unconfirmed revenue model)	Tamil Nadu job board, frontline/entry-level roles	Not found this pass
WhatsApp groups / local referral	Substitute	Free	How most hyper-local services are actually found in Tamil Nadu today	n/a

Full detail in `founder/competitors.csv`.

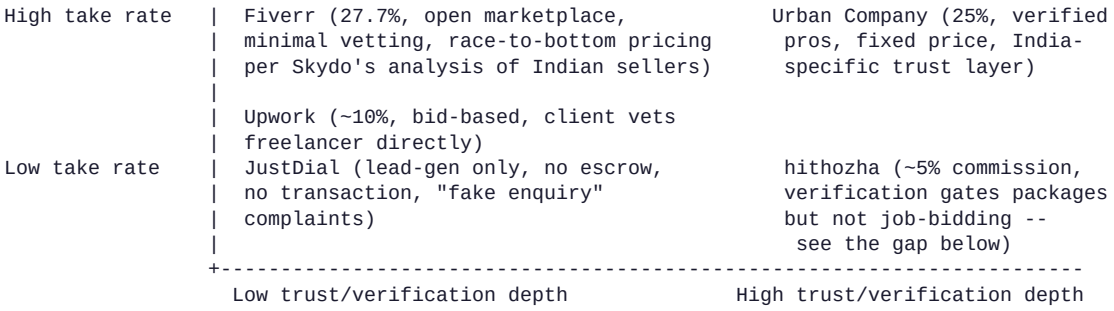
Price range

No single comparable "item" exists across these — Fiverr/Upwork/Urban Company are all commission-on-transaction models, not fixed menus, so the honest comparison is take rate, not item price:

- **Lowest take rate:** Upwork, ~10% typical (variable 0-15%).
- **Median:** Urban Company, 25% flat.
- **Highest:** Fiverr, ~27.7% all-in (20% seller commission + ~5.5% buyer fee).
- **hithozha's current ~5% default commission** undercuts all three by a wide margin — this is real and verifiable, not a rounding difference. It is the clearest, most defensible fact in this whole map.

Positioning map (text)

Two axes that matter here: **price (platform take rate)** vs. **trust/verification depth**.



WhatsApp groups / local referral sit off this grid entirely: zero take rate, and trust comes from the personal relationship, not a platform mechanism — which is exactly why they're a substitute, not a competitor. No platform fee beats free.

What their customers complain about (ranked, linked)

1. **Promised service not delivered / delayed — Urban Company.** The government consumer helpline logged 97 "delay in providing promised service" and 52 "promised service not provided" complaints (Jan 1 – Jul 22, 2025) — source: consumerhelpline.gov.in via search summary. Thin but consistent with the brand's core promise (verified pros) under real strain.

2. **Fake leads / fake enquiries — JustDial.** Multiple independent complainants on Voxya describe receiving "not a single genuine enquiry," all fake. This is the clearest articulated gap in the whole map: JustDial sells *discovery*, not a transaction, so nobody is accountable when the lead is junk.

3. **Funds held / account suspended without clear process — Fiverr.** A Trustpilot reviewer reports funds held 121 days with "zero support"; Indian sellers on a forum describe clients suspending active contracts specifically to withhold final payment — source: Trustpilot via search summary. Thin sample (anecdotal, not a counted theme) but it's a structural complaint about dispute resolution, which matters directly to the board's "no guarantee, no escrow" condition on hithozha.

4. **Worker-side burden, not buyer-side — Urban Company.** A 2024 Al Jazeera report describes partners facing qualifying fees, compulsory product purchases, and account blockings. Not a buyer complaint, but relevant: hithozha's freelancer-side economics (commission + plans) will face the same scrutiny if freelancers feel squeezed.

5. **Billing without consent — JustDial.** Complainants describe listings created without their consent and recurring ECS payments continuing after a business closed. Thin (self-selected complaint-site sample), flagged as thin per the skill's own rule.

The gap

Two gaps, matching the board's finding that this is two businesses:

• **On the hyper-local side:** nobody in this map combines (a) a real transaction with escrow- style trust, (b) Tamil-language-first UX, and (c) a take rate under 25%. Urban Company has (a) but not (b) and charges 5x hithozha's commission. JustDial has neither (a) nor (b) — it doesn't even complete a transaction, which is exactly what its "fake enquiry" complaints are about. WhatsApp/referral has (b) informally and (a) informally, at zero cost, which is the real competitor to beat, not a company. **The gap is real but narrow**: it only holds

if hithozha actually ships the verification/escrow layer the board flagged as currently missing on the job-bidding side. Without that, hithozha isn't ahead of Urban Company on trust — it's behind it with a cheaper price tag, which is not the same gap.

• **On the digital-gig side:** the gap is much weaker. Fiverr and Upwork have global liquidity, established buyer trust, and (per this search) no confirmed Tamil-first competitor exists — but a lower commission alone doesn't address why a global buyer would choose a Tamil Nadu- specific app over Fiverr's existing scale, and Tamil-speaking *sellers* can already sell on Fiverr/Upwork to global buyers today. This side's gap is thin; it matches the board's Monopoly lens finding that breadth here dilutes rather than strengthens the thesis.

The threat

ManyJobs.com (Matrimony.com group) is the most credible fast-copy threat found in this search — not because it does the same thing today (it's a job board, not a services marketplace), but because its parent, Matrimony.com, is an existing large, funded, Tamil Nadu-literate consumer company that already ships bilingual Tamil/English apps at scale and already moved into adjacent Tamil Nadu local-market apps in November 2024. If any player can credibly launch a Tamil-first services marketplace fast, with distribution Tamil Nadu already trusts, it's a company like this, not a Fiverr/Urban Company clone from outside. This matches the Monopoly lens's warning that the language edge is "real but thin and copyable."

The **Workers app** is a second, quieter threat: a local-services marketplace that already supports Tamil among five languages. It was not confirmed as Tamil Nadu-specific or Tamil-first in this pass, and its scale/ratings weren't found — but its existence means hithozha cannot claim to be the only multilingual local-services marketplace that happens to support Tamil; it can only claim to be built *for* Tamil Nadu first, which is a positioning claim, not yet a structural moat.

Next step: `/founder-consumer` — the fake-enquiry and delayed-service complaints above give real objections to test on the simulated buyer panel, instead of assumed ones.

3. Consumer Panel (20 simulated buyers)

Buyer panel: hithozha -- a Tamil-first app for booking hyper-local in-person services (home repair, tutoring, beauty/wellness, event services) in Tamil Nadu

3 buy · 17 pass (15% buy) out of 20 simulated buyers. Seed 997448, so the same cards can be dealt again.

These are simulated buyers, not customers. Use this to find objections and weak spots, then confirm the big ones with real people before you spend.

By segment

group	buyers	buy rate
Small business owner needing recurring local services	2	50% (thin)
Young urban professional (Chennai/Coimbatore)	7	14% (thin)
Middle-income household head (semi-urban)	7	14% (thin)
Older/traditional homeowner, less app-comfortable	4	0% (thin)

By buying behaviour

group	buyers	buy rate
JustDial caller	3	67% (thin)
Reads every review first	2	50% (thin)
Urban Company user (urban-only)	3	0% (thin)
Tries new apps early	2	0% (thin)
WhatsApp-group loyalist	6	0% (thin)
Trusts only a known face	2	0% (thin)
Deal hunter	2	0% (thin)

By income

group	buyers	buy rate
under $385,000	6	33% (thin)
$461,000 and up	7	14% (thin)
$385,000 to $461,000	7	0% (thin)

Why they pass

reason	buyers	in their words
trust	9	"I don't know this app from anywhere -- no one in my building or my WhatsApp groups has used it, and you're asking me to put my card into something brand new just to save a bit on the freelancer's cut. Urban Company already takes care of the verification headache for me, so the 5% fee pitch doesn't move me when the thing I actually worry about is who's holding my payment details." (P001) · "I'll download it because I always try the new local apps first, but downloading isn't booking -- I'm not letting someone into my home or handing a kid over to a tutor just because an ad looked slick. I'd want to know people near me are actually using it." (P003)
habit	8	"I already have a guy I call for plumbing, an AC man, a tailor -- people I've used for years or my neighbours vouched for. An app full of strangers, however verified, is not going to beat that overnight." (P002) · "My WhatsApp group already tells me who is good for this kind of work -- a neighbour vouches and that is enough for me. I do not open some new app to book someone for a repair or a tuition class, Tamil or not." (P005)

Why they buy

reason	buyers	in their words
trust	3	"Naan JustDial-la rendu moonu number call pannitu than aalu edukuven, but pathi per phone eduthadhe illa, fake listing dhan. Idhula identity verification iruku nu sonnudhadhal, oru try edukalam nu nenaikiren, konjam risk kammi irukum nu feel aguthu." (P004) · "The 5% fee instead of 25% and having it in Tamil are real pluses, so I'd try it once for something low-risk like a home cleaning, but that's as far as I'll go on a first try." (P016)

What would flip a no

- If a few people I actually know -- in Tamil, not some English review on the website -- had used it and gotten their money back cleanly when something went wrong, and if I could pay via UPI on completion

instead of upfront.

• If people in my own WhatsApp groups start saying they actually used it and got a good, fairly priced person -- or if my usual contact is suddenly unavailable and I need someone same-day -- I'd try it once to see.

• If a neighbour or someone in my building WhatsApp group had already booked someone real through it and said it went fine, I'd try booking too.

• If two or three people in my own apartment WhatsApp group had actually booked someone through it and said it worked out well, I would try it.

• If a neighbour in my WhatsApp group had already used it and said the freelancer showed up and did the job properly, or if the app clearly spelled out a no-show/bad-work refund policy -- then I'd try it once.

• A first-booking discount or referral code to actually push me to book, plus real customer ratings/reviews per freelancer (not just an identity check), and proof the Tamil experience is native, not translated.

• If two or three people in my own building's WhatsApp group actually used it and said it worked out well, I might try it once myself.

• If two or three people in my apartment WhatsApp group had actually booked someone through it and gotten what they paid for, I'd try it once.

• If two or three people in my own WhatsApp group had already used it and said the freelancer showed up on time and did good work -- then I'd try it, because that's basically the same trust I already use, just with an app attached.

• If someone I actually know -- a relative, a neighbour, someone in my building's WhatsApp group -- used hithozha for a repair or event job and told me it went well, I'd try it once myself.

• If someone in my own WhatsApp group had actually used it and vouched for a good experience, plus a clear written guarantee that a no-show or bad job gets refunded without a fight.

• If someone in my own WhatsApp group or a neighbour actually used a hithozha freelancer and vouched for them by name, I'd consider booking that same person through the app.

Buyers say they would buy **1.0 times** in the first month on average.

20 buyers gave all four price answers. Run founder-pricing's van_westendorp.py on the answers folder.

4. Pricing

Pricing: hithozha

An important correction before the numbers

The consumer panel's four price questions ("too cheap / a bargain / getting expensive / too expensive") asked buyers what they'd pay **for a local-service booking** — that's the freelancer's price to the buyer, which hithozha doesn't set. hithozha's own price, the thing it actually controls, is the **commission it takes from the freelancer** (currently ~5% default, lower on paid plans) plus the **subscription plan prices** for freelancers and clients. Both matter here, but they are not the same number, and the van Westendorp range below answers the first question, not the second.

Step 1: what buyers said (booking price, for context)

From `founder/pricing-curve.md` (20 complete answers, all given in ₹ per the panel transcripts — the tool's $ labels are a generic currency placeholder, read every figure below as rupees):

point	price	meaning
PMC	₹298.89	below this, too many think it's too cheap to be good
OPP	₹303.04	least resistance point
IPP	₹708.32	as many call it a bargain as call it expensive
PME	₹1,497.05	above this, too many won't buy

Acceptable range for a typical single local-service booking: ₹299 to ₹1,497. Useful as a sanity check for the freelancers who set prices on hithozha, not as hithozha's own price.

The more important finding from the panel isn't in this table: of the 17 buyers who passed, 9 cited trust and 8 cited habit as the reason — zero cited price as the primary blocker, and one buyer (P019) said explicitly "money is not his real barrier, trust is." **Price is not currently the binding constraint on hithozha's hyper-local side.** Discounting the commission further, or running a buyer-side promotion, would not move the buy rate on this evidence — the panel's own "what would flip a no" answers (`founder/panel/results.md`) are almost entirely about social proof, not cost. Treat that as the headline for `/founder-marketing` and `/founder-offer`, not this pricing table.

Step 2: what competitors charge (take rate, not booking price)

From `founder/competitors.md` — these are platform commissions, the actual lever hithozha controls, compared like-for-like:

platform	take rate
Upwork	~10% typical (variable 0-15%)
Urban Company	25% (cut from 30% in 2021)
Fiverr	~27.7% all-in (20% + ~5.5% buyer fee)

platform	take rate
hithozha	**~5% default, lower on paid plans**

hithozha's commission undercuts every one of these by a wide margin. That is real and verifiable — but the panel result above means it is not currently the thing winning or losing buyers. It matters more to the *freelancer's* decision to list on hithozha over a competitor than to the *buyer's* decision to book through it.

Step 3: what the business needs

Not available yet. `/founder-cfo` hasn't run, so there is no `founder/numbers.json` and no unit-economics check on whether 5% commission covers hithozha's own costs (payment processing, support, verification checks) at realistic order volumes. This is a genuine open question, not a guess — flagged here per this skill's own rule ("do not invent a range"), and will be revisited once `/founder-cfo` produces real numbers. If 5% turns out too thin to cover costs, that's a constraint from the business side, independent of what buyers said.

Step 4: the decision

1. **The commission price stays at ~5% for now** — not because the panel asked for a lower number (it didn't; price wasn't the blocker), but because it's already a genuine, defensible differentiator against every competitor in the map, and because there is no evidence yet (pending `/founder-cfo`) that it's unsustainable. **This is provisional, not final — revisit the moment the CFO numbers exist.**

2. **The ladder is the subscription plans, not booking price**: a free tier (current ~5% commission, base limits), and paid freelancer/client plans (lower commission, higher open- job/package limits) — which the brief says already exists as a mechanic. The step-up reason for each rung should be capacity (more open jobs/packages) and take-home (lower commission), not a buyer-facing discount, since buyers aren't the ones price-blocked.

3. **No opening offer on price.** Given the panel's finding, a launch discount on commission or booking price would spend money solving a problem buyers didn't report having. The opening offer that would actually move the buy rate is a **trust offer**, not a price one — see `/founder-offer`, next.

4. **What to test with real buyers:** not two prices — two *trust signals*, since that's what the panel says actually gates the decision. For example: (a) a visible "N people in your area have booked through hithozha" counter vs. (b) a specific no-show/bad-job refund guarantee stated up front. Test which one moves a real pilot group's booking rate more; price A/B testing is not the next experiment to run on this evidence.

5. **The panel's top three price-adjacent quotes** (for marketing to have on hand, even though they're not the dominant objection):

• "The 5% fee instead of 25% and having it in Tamil are real pluses, so I'd try it once for something low-risk like a home cleaning, but that's as far as I'll go on a first try." (P016)

• "Naan JustDial-la rendu moonu number call pannitu than aalu edukuven, but pathi per phone eduthadhe illa, fake listing dhan. Idhula identity verification iruku nu sonnudhadhal, konjam risk kammi irukum nu feel aguthu." (P004 — on the verification claim mattering more than the fee)

• "money is not his real barrier, trust is" (P019, paraphrased from the panel's own summary)

Next step: `/founder-offer` — build the trust-answering offer the panel is actually asking for (a guarantee, visible social proof, or both) before `/founder-cfo` checks whether the business can afford to keep commission at ~5% while paying for whatever that offer costs.

5. Offer

Offer: hithozha

Built from the panel's own evidence (`founder/panel/results.md`), not a guess. 9 of 17 passes cited trust, 8 cited habit, 0 cited price — so this offer stacks trust mechanisms, not a discount.

Step 2: the problem list (buyer's words, from the panel + competitor complaints)

Before booking

1. "I don't know this app from anywhere" — zero social proof (P001).
2. "No one in my building/WhatsApp group has used it" — repeated in nearly every pass (P005, P011, P013, P014, P015, and more).
3. "I already have a guy I call for this" — switching cost against an existing habit (P002, P011, P018).
4. "How do I know this verified freelancer is actually any good?" — identity verification doesn't prove skill (P016, P020).
5. "Is this app actually in Tamil, or just translated labels?" — authenticity doubt (P007, P015).
6. "This feels like it's for English-speaking city people, not people like me" (P008, P011).
7. "I don't trust giving payment details to a new app" (P001, P019).
8. "Will there be enough freelancers near me, or will I open the app and find nobody?" (P003, P020).
9. Fake/dead listings on JustDial (`founder/competitors.md`) — primes distrust of any new discovery claim, hithozha included.

During the booking

10. "What happens if the person doesn't show up or does a bad job — do I get my money back?" — the single most repeated concern across both buyers and non-buyers (P004, P008, P012, P018).
11. No visible per-freelancer ratings or completed-job history in the pitch — only "identity verified" is shown, which buyers correctly say isn't the same thing (P016, P020).
12. Must enter payment details upfront rather than pay on completion (P001).

After the booking

13. No stated guarantee or refund policy — its absence is noted explicitly, unprompted, by multiple buyers.
14. No accountability path if something goes wrong, unlike a known personal contact (P002, P012).
15. Urban Company's own delay/non-delivery complaints (97 + 52 logged, `founder/competitors.md`) show this isn't a hypothetical risk category — it happens even to the market leader.
16. The board's own finding: verification gates packages but not job-bidding — an inconsistency that would undermine the "verified" claim the moment a buyer or reviewer probes it.

Step 3: solutions, trimmed and stacked

problem	solution	value (1-5)	cost (1-5, estimated — CFO to confirm)
10, 13, 14	Escrow-style "Show up or it's free" guarantee: buyer's payment is held, not released to the freelancer, until the buyer confirms the job was done	5	3 (dispute-handling ops cost, not cash cost — the held money was never hithozha's to lose)
4, 11	Per-freelancer star rating + completed-job count shown before booking, not just an "identity verified" badge	5	2 (product/ops: aggregate existing order data, already captured by the schema)
1, 2, 7, 12	"Pay on completion" via UPI instead of entering payment details upfront	4	3 (payment-flow rework + fraud-risk review needed)
1, 2	Honest, real "N completed bookings near you" counter — shown as the true number, including a low or zero count in a brand-new area, never fabricated	3	1 (just a query against real data; the real cost is in `/founder-launch`'s job of making that number non-zero before claiming it widely)
16	Close the verification asymmetry: require the same identity verification for job-bidding as for packages, or state explicitly why not	4	2 (policy decision + enforcement in the existing RLS/RPC layer)
5, 6	Native-reviewed Tamil copy throughout the booking flow, not just labels (ties to the earlier Tamil-translation review work already done on the category taxonomy)	3	1
8	Honest coverage indicator per category/area ("X verified pros near you") instead of implying universal coverage	3	1

Cut from the stack (low value or cost this skill can't justify without more evidence):

- A referral/invite bonus (cash or credit for inviting a neighbour) — plausible given the panel's own ask, but needs `/founder-cfo` to confirm what it costs per activated referral before promising it. Flagged for the CFO step, not committed here.
- Any buyer-side discount — the pricing step already found price isn't the blocker; a discount would spend money solving a problem that wasn't reported.

The stack

- **The core** (outcome-framed): *Book a local service in Tamil Nadu from a verified pro, and don't pay until you know the job was actually done.*
- **Bonus 1 — Per-freelancer rating & job history**, shown before booking, not after.

• **Bonus 2 — Real completed-bookings-near-you counter**, true to the actual number always.

• **Bonus 3 — Pay-on-completion (UPI on delivery)**, no upfront payment details required.

• **The guarantee — "Show up or it's free."** Payment released to the freelancer only after the buyer confirms completion; a no-show or a confirmed bad job is refunded from the held funds, not from hithozha's own margin. **Cost to hithozha at a realistic claim rate is not yet modeled —** `/founder-cfo` **must confirm this before it's promised publicly.**

• **Urgency (honest, not fabricated):** hithozha is onboarding its first batch of verified pros in one chosen city/category at a time (per the board's narrowing condition) — "first batch" framing is literally true during that rollout, not a manufactured countdown.

• **The name: "Book Safe, Pay on Delivery."**

Step 4: the value equation, before and after

element	before	after	what moved it
Dream outcome	6	7	The core promise is sharpened from "book a verified pro" to "don't pay until the job's actually done" — a clearer, more specific outcome.
Perceived likelihood	3	6	The escrow guarantee and per-freelancer ratings directly answer the panel's two loudest doubts ("verified ≠ good," "what if they don't show"). Not higher than 6: zero real social proof still exists at true cold start, and that can't be manufactured honestly.
Time to result	7	7	Unchanged — the booking flow itself isn't faster or slower.
Effort / sacrifice	4	6	Pay-on-completion removes the single most concrete fear in the panel (handing payment details to an unknown app) — a real reduction in what the buyer risks upfront.

Step 5: re-test

New pitch written to `founder/pitch.md` (old one kept as `founder/pitch-v1.md`). Re-running `/founder-consumer` on the same 20 personas (seed 997448) with the new offer — result below once the panel completes.